

Module 8: Migration Journey and Experience

Signature Learning Experience

Purpose

This module's material is human, not abstract, so its assignment centers real journeys — analyzed ethically. Students work with published first-person narratives (memoirs, oral history archives, documentary testimony) or, with training and consent protocols, an original interview, and analyze one journey through the module's frameworks: stages, risks, trauma, resilience.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Describe the stages of migration visible in a real narrative (UG 1)
- Identify risks — trafficking, exploitation, detention — as they actually appeared (UG 2)
- Explain emotional and psychological impacts using module frameworks, not amateur diagnosis (UG 3)
- Recognize how gender, age, and other factors shaped the journey (UG 4)

Graduate extension

Graduate students conducting original interviews follow the full ethics protocol (consent, right to withdraw, no trauma solicitation) and analyze their material against trauma-informed frameworks from the literature, noting where frameworks fit poorly (Grad 1–2). Interviews require completed ethics training; instructor confirms whether IRB review applies.

Assignment steps

1. Complete the mandatory ethics briefing before starting: consent, dignity, no re-traumatization, the difference between analyzing a narrative and mining it.
2. Choose your source: a published memoir or long-form testimony, a curated oral history archive (e.g., UNHCR storytelling projects, StoryCorps, university archives) — or, for approved students, an original interview with someone who has consented in writing.
3. Map the journey against the module's stage framework: decision, departure, transit, arrival, adjustment — noting where the real journey defies the tidy model.
4. Analyze two dimensions in depth (e.g., gendered risk and resilience strategies; child vulnerability and family separation; trauma and post-arrival mental health).
5. Write the analysis, quoting the narrative sparingly and respectfully — the person is the expert on their experience; you are analyzing structures, not judging choices.
6. Include a 300-word ethics reflection: what you chose not to use, and why.

Deliverables & format

- Narrative analysis, 1,500–1,800 words (graduate: 2,500 with framework critique)
- Journey map (visual or structured outline)
- Ethics reflection (300 words); signed consent form if an original interview was conducted

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Ethical handling of the material — demonstrated, not asserted 25%	Conduct is impeccable: ethical handling of the material — demonstrated, not asserted is demonstrated throughout, protocols are followed without exception, and the work shows active care for the people and communities involved.	Conduct is sound: ethical handling of the material — demonstrated, not asserted is evident with only minor lapses that do not affect participants or partners, and all required protocols are followed.	Conduct is uneven: ethical handling of the material — demonstrated, not asserted is addressed but with gaps — a missed protocol step, careless handling of sensitive material, or boundary issues requiring instructor follow-up.	Conduct falls short of requirements: ethical handling of the material — demonstrated, not asserted is neglected in ways that required intervention or placed participants, partners, or material at risk.
Accurate use of stage, risk, and trauma frameworks 30%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: accurate use of stage, risk, and trauma frameworks goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: accurate use of stage, risk, and trauma frameworks is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: accurate use of stage, risk, and trauma frameworks is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: accurate use of stage, risk, and trauma frameworks is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.
Depth of the two-dimension analysis 25%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: depth of the two-dimension analysis goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: depth of the two-dimension analysis is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: depth of the two-dimension analysis is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: depth of the two-dimension analysis is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Respectful, precise writing 20%	Communication is publication-ready: respectful, precise writing is achieved with precise, well-organized prose, correct citation, and figures or formats that make the argument easier to grasp.	Communication is clear and professional: respectful, precise writing is achieved with minor lapses in polish, organization, or citation that never obscure meaning.	Communication is understandable but rough: respectful, precise writing is only partly achieved — disorganization, citation errors, or unclear figures make the reader work to follow the argument.	Communication impedes the work: respectful, precise writing is not achieved; errors, disorganization, or missing citations obscure the substance.